
OREGON STATE PARKS VOLUNTEER-PROGRAM CONTROLS

TO Oregon Secretary of State, Audits Division

FROM Robert Samuel White, P.O. Box 334, Reedsport, Oregon 97467

DATE September 21, 2026

RE Request for performance audit consideration

TESTIMONY v1.9

My name is Robert Samuel White. In 2025, I served without compensation as a park host at Jessie M. Honeyman Memorial State Park. I later asked the Director of Oregon State Parks to examine how the Department had handled my service and to establish protections for other volunteers. I preserved the correspondence and the records that followed.¹ ([Testimony v1.9, p. 239](#))

I am writing to the Audits Division because this record raises questions about agency controls, not because I expect an audit to decide my individual dispute. The Division’s published audit plan describes a risk-based process that considers how many Oregonians an agency affects and then examines risks involving health, safety, and agency programs.² Oregon State Parks operates a statewide volunteer program. The record in my case shows one path for a volunteer complaint and another for referring that volunteer’s correspondence to law enforcement. I am asking whether the controls governing those paths warrant examination.^{1,4} ([Testimony v1.9, p. 259](#))

On August 24, 2025, I asked the Director for five things: an investigation of the conduct I reported, consequences for managers who use coercive tactics against volunteers, protection from retaliation, a grievance process independent of the managers whose conduct is being reported, and training and oversight for volunteer supervision. I stated that I was not seeking an apology or a personal remedy. I was asking for protections for future volunteers.¹ ([Testimony v1.9, p. 241](#))

The Director answered the next day. She wrote that she took concerns about the volunteer program seriously and would make sure my concerns were reviewed through the appropriate channels within the Department. Her response did not identify the channel, the person responsible for the review, the standard that would govern it, or how I would be told its result.³ ([Testimony v1.9, p. 242](#))

On December 8, 2025, the Director ended the correspondence. She wrote that she did not believe further correspondence would lead to the resolution I was seeking. Her letter did not report a completed review, identify a finding, name a corrective action, or address the five protections I requested.⁵ ([Testimony v1.9, p. 249](#))

The matter later moved from a request for institutional review to a police operation. The Oregon State Police production contains a March 3, 2026 email from an OPRD emergency manager to an OSP captain, copied to OPRD’s deputy director. The email said it was being shared for situational awareness because I was including the Governor and the Director in my correspondence. The next morning, an OSP captain requested a threat assessment. The matter went to the Major Crimes Section.⁴ ([Testimony v1.9, p. 259](#)) ([Testimony v1.9, p. 260](#))

OSP detectives and a United States Forest Service special agent came to my home and workplace on March 24, 2026. The completed OSP report states that I made no direct threats, showed no apparent movement toward violence or violent behavior, did not appear to be escalating on a pathway to violence, and had committed no identified crime. The case was closed for information only with no further action.⁴ ([Testimony v1.9, p. 263](#)) ([Testimony v1.9, p. 264](#))

That sequence presents a control problem. The Director promised an internal review without identifying the process or later reporting what it produced. The Department then sent my correspondence outside the agency for a threat assessment that used Major Crimes personnel and ended without evidence of a crime or an identified threat.^{3,4,5} ([Testimony v1.9, p. 242](#)) ([Testimony v1.9, p. 264](#))

I ask the Audits Division to consider the following questions based on those records.^{3,4}

1. What process governs a complaint by an OPRD volunteer when the complaint concerns the volunteer's supervisors?
2. What record must be created when the Director promises departmental review, and who verifies that the review occurred?
3. What standards and approvals govern an OPRD referral of a volunteer's correspondence and public criticism to law enforcement?
4. What risk assessment, record-preservation, and after-action review controls apply when such a referral results in a Major Crimes investigation and a visit to the volunteer's home and workplace?^{3,4}

The archive linked below preserves the correspondence as rendered documents and unmodified email originals. The testimony organizes those records into a numbered account, but the records themselves are the basis of this request. I ask the Division to consider these questions in its audit-selection process and to tell me whether its staff would use a different submission route or require additional material.^{1,2,4} ([Testimony v1.9, p. 264](#))

Respectfully,

Robert Samuel White

Sources

1. [An Open Letter, August 24, 2025](#). Oregon Parks and Recreation Department correspondence record.
2. [2026–27 Audit Plan for Performance Audits](#). Oregon Secretary of State, Audits Division.
3. [The Director's response to the open letter, August 25, 2025](#). Oregon Parks and Recreation Department correspondence record.
4. [OSP production containing the OPRD referral and threat-assessment file, September 3, 2026](#). Oregon State Police correspondence record and attachments.
5. [The Director's closing letter, December 8, 2025](#). Oregon Parks and Recreation Department correspondence record.